



Anonymize your documents, in full confidence

100% local anonymization of personal data in your texts and Word files.

- ✓ **100% local processing** – nothing is sent over the Internet during anonymization
- ✓ **Two-panel interface** – Source on the left, Result on the right
- ✓ **Text and Word** – `.txt`, `.md` and `.docx` files (formatting preserved)
- ✓ **Automatic detection** – names, emails, phone numbers, addresses, dates...

Version **1.3.0**

www.openprivacy.ch

⚠ Important – software not signed by Apple / Microsoft

Your system may display a security warning on first launch. This is normal for a distribution without a paid publisher certificate. This guide explains, step by step, how to authorize OpenPrivacy with confidence.

Download

- 1 Go to <https://www.openprivacy.ch>
- 2 Click **Download for Mac** (or use the file provided by your firm / IT department).
- 3 Keep the file `OpenPrivacy-mac.zip` in a folder you'll easily find (Desktop, Documents...).

Authorize the application (Mac)

Why this warning?

OpenPrivacy is not signed with an Apple Developer ID certificate. macOS blocks apps downloaded outside the App Store as a precaution. If you downloaded it from [openprivacy.ch](https://www.openprivacy.ch), you can authorize the app by following the steps below.

Message "developer cannot be verified"

Recommended method (the simplest)

- 1 **Do not double-click** the icon the first time.
- 2 **Right-click** (or Ctrl + click) on `OpenPrivacy.app` → **Open**.
- 3 In the dialog box, click **Open** again (not Cancel).

✓ Tip

macOS remembers your choice: subsequent launches work with a simple double-click.

If the application is still blocked

- 1 Open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**.
- 2 Scroll down to the **Security** section.
- 3 If the message "OpenPrivacy.app was blocked" appears, click **Open Anyway**.
- 4 Confirm with your administrator password if prompted.

Extract the ZIP file correctly

- 1 Double-click `OpenPrivacy-mac.zip` to extract it.
- 2 Move `OpenPrivacy.app` to the **Applications** folder (recommended) or leave it in Documents.
- 3 **Do not launch** the application directly from the ZIP archive without extracting it.

Authorize the application (Windows)

(When the Windows version becomes available.)

Why does SmartScreen appear?

Windows filters executables whose publisher is not commercially recognized. Unblock the file then confirm execution – only if the source is trusted.

Unblock the file after download

- 1 Right-click `OpenPrivacy-windows.zip` → **Properties**.
- 2 At the bottom of the **General** tab, check **Unblock** if the box is present → **OK**.
- 3 Extract the ZIP (**Extract All...**) into a fixed folder, e.g. `Documents\OpenPrivacy`.

Bypass SmartScreen on first launch

- 1 Double-click `OpenPrivacy.exe`.
- 2 If a blue SmartScreen window appears: click **More info**.
- 3 Then **Run anyway**.

If the antivirus blocks the executable

Contact your IT department: they can add an exception for the `OpenPrivacy` folder or verify the integrity of the file downloaded from `openprivacy.ch`.

First launch

Activation (free key)

On first start, a window asks for your **activation key** (format `OP-...`).

- Get a key at <https://www.openprivacy.ch> (access section).
- **Only the key** is verified online – **never** the content of your documents.
- Once validated, the key is stored locally (offline use possible for several days).

Engine download (~3 GB)

- An **Internet connection** is required **once** to download the anonymization model.
- The status bar at the bottom of the window shows progress ("downloading model..." then "Ready").
- Expect **10 to 30 minutes** depending on your connection. Subsequent launches are fast (a few seconds).
- Allow at least **5 GB of free disk space**.

Interface (version 1.3)

The application displays **two panels** side by side:

Area	Role
Source (left)	Text or preview of the document to process
Result (right)	Anonymized text or Word confirmation

Toolbar

Button	Action
Anonymize	Starts local processing
Open...	Choose a .txt, .md, .docx... file
Save...	Save the result
Clear	Empty the text areas

A **badge** at the top right indicates the mode (**Text** or **Word**). Error or success messages appear as a **notification** at the bottom right.

Daily use

- 1 Launch **OpenPrivacy** (Applications or shortcut).
- 2 Wait for the **"Ready"** status at the bottom of the window.
- 3 **Paste** your text into the **Source** panel, or click **Open...** to load a file.
- 4 Click **Anonymize**.
- 5 Check the **Result** panel: for text, click **Save...** to export a `.txt` ; for Word, a file `Name_anonymized.docx` is created next to the original.

Example

Before	After
Mr. Dupont, Rue du Rhône 14, 1204 Geneva. Contact: dupont@cabinet-ge.ch	Mr. <PRIVATE_PERSON>, <PRIVATE_ADDRESS>. Contact: <PRIVATE_EMAIL>

The exact labels vary depending on the type of data detected.

Word files

- Supported formats: `.docx` only.
- Older `.doc` files must be converted to `.docx` in Microsoft Word.
- Formatting (styles, tables, headers) is largely preserved.

Frequently asked questions

Why does macOS or Windows block the application?

Operating systems primarily trust software signed by registered publishers. OpenPrivacy is distributed without this commercial signature; follow the "Authorize the application" section above.

Does my data go over the Internet?

No, during anonymization. Only the first download of the model and the verification of the activation key use the Internet.

Can I work offline?

Yes, after the first download of the model and a successful activation (local cache of the key).

Does the tool guarantee GDPR / FADP compliance?

No. It is an aid to reducing personal data. Human review remains recommended for sensitive matters.

The application won't start

Check: disk space (5 GB+), macOS/Windows authorization (sections above), Internet connection on first launch. Note the error message displayed and contact your support.

The Anonymize button stays greyed out

The engine is still loading: wait for the "Ready" status at the bottom of the window.

Support

- Website and activation key: <https://www.openprivacy.ch>
- PDF guide: https://www.openprivacy.ch/GUIDE_UTILISATEUR_EN.pdf
- For enterprise installation: contact the person who provided you with the software (firm, IT, publisher).